

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

AI Literacy • Lesson 5 of 6

THE TASK BOARD LESSON

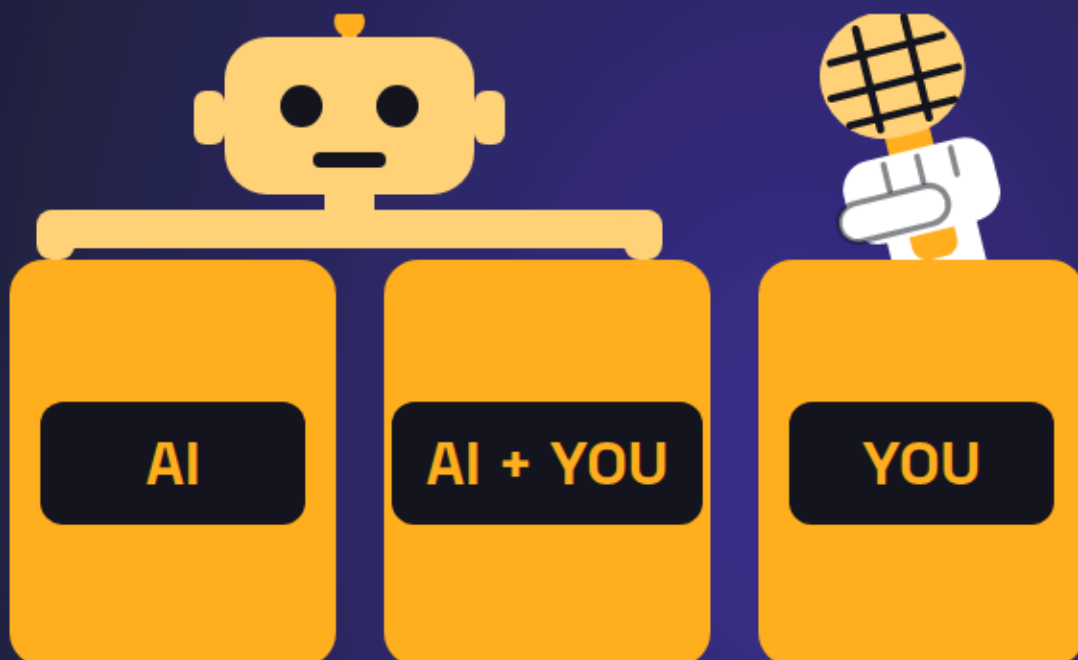
Robots Do the Boring Work

AI takes **tasks** first, not whole jobs.

Grades 6–8

45-min lesson

No prep • No devices needed



STUDENT SESSION

The Studio Task Board



Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

You're on the crew at **Big Dream Studio**, a small recording studio. **Nia** owns the place and coaches the artists. **Ravi** runs the mixing boards. **Jaylen** runs the front desk. There's too much to do, so the crew just got an AI assistant. Your job: decide what it does, and what it never touches. Heads up: "making the call" means deciding. And every call has a **trade**: someone wins, someone loses something, and something could go wrong. (Grown-ups call it a *tradeoff*.)

- **AUTOMATE** — boring and repeating. No decisions to make. Hand it to AI.
- **AUGMENT** — a human makes the call, AI helps out.
- **KEEP HUMAN** — coaching, taste, being there for someone. The person is the whole point.

THIS WEEK AT BIG DREAM STUDIO

- | | |
|--|--|
| <p>A. Send the "don't forget your session" texts (Jaylen)</p> <p>B. Rename and back up last night's 300 audio files (Ravi)</p> <p>C. Write the first draft of this week's social media captions (Jaylen)</p> <p>D. Mix a rough first version of a new artist's song (Ravi)</p> <p>E. Coach a nervous first-time singer through their first recording (Nia)</p> <p>F. Politely remind three people who still haven't paid the studio (Jaylen)</p> | <p>G. Pick which of an artist's five songs drops first (Nia)</p> <p>H. Set up the microphone for a live band and fix the echo (Ravi)</p> <p>I. Agree on a price with a group that wants the studio for three days (Nia)</p> <p>J. Type up the lyrics from yesterday's freestyle rap session (Ravi)</p> <p>K. Answer the same five questions everyone emails (price, hours, parking) (Jaylen)</p> <p>L. Plan the song order and mood for show night (Nia)</p> |
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PORT THE BOARD

Write each task's letter on your own board, in the column where it belongs. A column can hold lots of letters, but every column needs at least two. Disagree with your partner? Good — talk it out. That's the lesson.

AUTOMATE — HAND IT TO AI

AUGMENT — AI HELPS OUT

KEEP HUMAN — PEOPLE STUFF

THE TASK BOARD LESSON • LESSON 5 OF 6

Robots Do the Boring Work



A 45-minute lesson on AI and future jobs. Your class runs a busy recording studio and decides which tasks go to AI, which get AI's help, and which stay human. Every choice has a trade, and students defend theirs out loud. Stands alone.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Studio Task Board worksheet (2 pages, 1 per student; fillable PDF copy included) • Slides (optional; script and keys in the notes) • board + marker for the three columns • Defense Rubric (Teacher Guide p.3) • pens	None — fully unplugged. Optional: a projector for the slides	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES & STANDARDS

- Sort real job tasks into **automate** / **augment** / **keep human** and explain the difference. (*Sort the Board; Exit Ticket*)
- Compare the tradeoffs of an automation choice — who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong. (*trade cards; Exit Ticket AUTOMATE line*)
- Defend a sorting decision aloud: a clear claim, a specific detail, eyes up, every word heard. (*Defend It — listener strip + Defense Rubric*)

CSTA SC-20

CCSS ELA SL.6.4

ISTE 1.3.d

WARM-UP — THE MOST BORING JOB EVER (7 MIN)

Ask: "What's the most boring job you can think of?" Board 4–5 answers, then push on two or three of them:

"Is it boring because it **REPEATS** — same thing, over and over, no decisions? Or is it 'boring' but full of people stuff — helping, noticing, calming someone down?" Sort them as a class: repeats → give it to a robot; people stuff → keep it human. (A cafeteria cashier's job repeats — but the cashier also knows which kid forgot lunch money. Let them argue; the arguing is the point.)

Bridge (on slide 3, give pairs 30 seconds to talk first): "Here's the honest version, no robot apocalypse. Nobody can promise which jobs change, or how many. So far, AI mostly takes over tasks, not whole jobs. Usually the boring, repeating ones. But every time a business automates something, somebody wins, somebody loses something, and something could go wrong. Today YOU make those decisions — for a recording studio."

What if nobody names a people-stuff job? Try: "Bus driver — repeats the route, but notices who's crying in row six."

Transition: "So how do you decide what a robot should take? Three columns. Eyes on the board."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — THREE COLUMNS, ONE QUESTION (10 MIN)

Draw three columns on the board (slide 4 if projecting) and define them. Say it out loud once: a "call" is a decision.

AUTOMATE — boring and repeating. No decisions to make. Hand it to AI.

AUGMENT — a human makes the call, AI helps out.

KEEP HUMAN — coaching, taste, being there for someone. The person is the whole point.

Tell the BPM story (1 min): "Back in the day, DJs counted every song's BPM, its beats per minute, by hand. Boring. But all that counting taught them the ins and outs of mixing. Now the software just tells you. The counting got automated. The job didn't. So who won? And who lost something?" *Listen for: they got time back, but beginners skip the lesson the counting taught.*

📁 THE TRADE — EVERY CHOICE HAS A COST

Pick **TWO** letters from your board, the two you argued about most, and write the trade for each.

Choice #1 — Task letter: _____

☐ AUTOMATE ☐ AUGMENT ☐ KEEP HUMAN

Who wins? _____

Who loses something? _____

What could go wrong? _____

Choice #2 — Task letter: _____

☐ AUTOMATE ☐ AUGMENT ☐ KEEP HUMAN

Who wins? _____

Who loses something? _____

What could go wrong? _____

📁 DEFEND IT — SAY IT OUT LOUD

1. Write your claim in the box (2 min). Then two pairs sit together: face one person from the other pair.
2. **Speaker 1** is the partner whose first name comes first in the alphabet. Read your claim out loud (30 sec).
3. Three moves: **eyes up**, every word clear, **slow down** on "because." Then slide the sheet across.
4. **Listener**: check the boxes, write one keep and one fix (30 sec), and slide it back. Switch roles.

Task _____ belongs in _____

because _____

— and the trade is _____

☐ Eyes up ☐ Heard every word ☐ Slowed down on "because" Keep: _____

Fix: _____

📁 EXIT TICKET — A REAL JOB YOU KNOW

Pick a real job someone in your life has (family, neighbor, coach, teacher). Sort three of its tasks.

The job: _____

AUTOMATE — one boring, repeating task AI should take. Who loses something when it does?

AUGMENT — one task where the human makes the call and AI helps out.

KEEP HUMAN — one task that should stay fully human, and why.

